

Katherine Tosi

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**SENIOR EDUCATION LEADER | TEACHING & LEARNING | STUDENT SERVICES & INCLUSION |
CURRICULUM DESIGN | IB, IGCSE, A-LEVEL, LIBERAL ARTS | AI & ACADEMIC INTEGRITY | EAP/EMI**

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior education leader with 34 years of experience across 6 countries (USA, Switzerland, Thailand, Australia, Myanmar, and China), specializing in curriculum design, instructional leadership, student services, and institutional building in bilingual and international settings. Track record of designing and launching new curricula from concept to delivery, building whole-school academic and student support frameworks from inception, leading and developing high-performing teams, and driving measurable improvements in student attainment. Deep experience with the IB Diploma Programme, IGCSE, A-Level, English National Curriculum, and undergraduate liberal arts (Middle States accreditation). Currently completing the National Professional Qualification for Headship at UCL Institute of Education (expected May 2027).

LEADERSHIP AREAS

Curriculum design, oversight, and quality assurance	Student services, inclusion, SEN/SENCO, and equitable access
Instructional leadership and teaching excellence	Leading and developing teams: CPD, mentoring
Admissions assessment and progression systems	EAP, EMI, and multilingual learner support
AI literacy, digital learning, and academic integrity	DEI strategy, student belonging, and first-year experience
Safeguarding, child protection, and student wellbeing	Sustainability education and UN SDGs
Cross-cultural leadership in multilingual environments	Experiential and community-based learning design
Accreditation readiness (CIS/WASC, IB, Middle States)	Debate, argumentation, and public speaking programs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

New York University Shanghai, China

**Senior Lecturer | Community Connections (DEI) Faculty Chair | Center for Student Belonging Facilitator
| UN Millennium Fellowship Campus Point of Contact**

August 2018 – Present

China's first Sino-US research university and the third degree-granting campus of the NYU Global Network. Nearly 2,000 students from 70+ countries. English-medium liberal arts curriculum. LEED Gold campus. Accredited by the Middle States Commission on Higher Education.

- Designed and launched **4 new courses** from concept to full delivery: Future Focused (Future of Work), (Un)Sustainability, Systems Thinking, and The History of Rock and Roll. Awarded a competitive **Experiential Learning Curriculum Design Fellowship** (Center for Teaching and Learning, Fall 2023).
- Taught **500+ first-year students from 70+ countries** at NYU Shanghai since 2018 across English for Academic Purposes courses. All original course materials (no textbook).
- Built complete assessment architecture, learning outcomes, experiential components, community partnerships, and alignment with institutional goals for each course.
- **Chair, Faculty Community Connections (DEI) initiatives:** equity strategy, curriculum review, faculty engagement, and community-building across the institution.
- **Coordinated Community Connections guest speaker event** with the Writing Program: *Black Girl from Pyongyang: Identity, Home, and Being Seen*, a talk and panel discussion with memoirist Monica Macías (September 22, 2026). 65 students attended.
- **Workshop Facilitator, Center for Student Belonging** (2023, Summer 2025, Fall 2025): strengthening inclusive campus culture.

- **Co-Facilitator, LEAD mentorship program** for first-generation and underrepresented students (8 mentees).
- **Campus Point of Contact and Advisor, UN Millennium Fellowship** (involved since 2023 launch at NYU Shanghai: began by nominating students, served as referee and advisor, appointed Campus Point of Contact in 2026). The university's designated liaison to the global program (15,000+ fellows, 330+ campuses, 48 countries). Mentors students from coursework into funded social-impact projects.
- **Co-authored the 48-page EAP Academic Program Review Self-Study** (March 2026) with Marcel Daniels (Area Head), Steve Iams (Assistant Dean for Academic Affairs), and Catherine Journeaux. Co-wrote the department's **strategic vision and five-year plan** with Iams, recognized as the official direction for the program, repositioning EAP as the **Center for Academic Inquiry (CAI)**: a required first-year academic experience integrating AI literacy, digital literacy, ethical reasoning, and experiential learning.
- Integrated **AI literacy and digital skills** into the academic curriculum; led faculty engagement on responsible AI use in teaching and assessment.
- **Chair, Culture and Heritage Exposition** (inaugural event, Community Connections).
- **Advisor, Collective Voice Student Debate** (2019-2021, 2024). Adjudicator at NYUSH/Cornell English Speech and Debate Pentathlon.
- **Director and Performer**, faculty-student production of *The Great Gatsby* (2024).
- Built a **community-engaged experiential learning model** embedding 4-5 hours of assessed voluntary service into coursework. Students volunteered with Shanghai non-profits including **Stepping Stones Shanghai, Good-hope Bakery of Special Youth, Shanggong Elder Nursing Home**, and **ZROU** (whose student-run SDG campaign led to a permanent vegan/halal stall in the NYU Shanghai cafeteria). Stepping Stones partnership initiated at Harrow (2016) and sustained through NYU Shanghai.
- Co-founded **NYU Shanghai Sustainability Committee** through direct outreach to the NYU Office of Sustainability; committee now drives 14+ campus initiatives (LEED Gold campus).
- Faculty Advisor, **Green Shanghai** student environmental club (2018-2020): integrated UN SDGs into student activism.
- Event Ambassador, **No Translation Needed** cross-cultural understanding initiative.
- Member, **Space Use Committee**.

Harrow International School Shanghai, China

Director of Student Services, Nursery through Year 13

August 2016 – August 2018

A British international school serving students aged 18 months to 18 years, part of the Harrow International Schools network.

Approximately 1,200 students.

- Recruited to create the school's first comprehensive student support and academic intervention framework across all divisions (N-13). **Designed and implemented the full system within 12 months**: assessment pathways, identification and referral structures, individualized education plans, admissions screening protocols, faculty training, intervention monitoring, and safeguarding procedures.
- Conducted **300+ student assessments annually**; used baseline data to monitor academic progress across all year groups.
- **Trained K-13 faculty** in inclusive practice, differentiation, CLIL methodology, and classroom-based support for diverse learners.
- Transformed admissions and placement through **data-informed assessment**, improving equitable access.
- Developed and implemented **Individualized Education Plans** for students with additional learning needs.
- Contributed to strategic and operational planning as a **key member of the school leadership team**.
- Initiated the **Stepping Stones Shanghai** partnership (2016).
- Organized **debate tournaments** (Learning Leaders, Association for Global Debate International Invitational).

Dulwich College Beijing, China

Professional Development Coordinator | Head of EAL/Student Support | IB English B Teacher

August 2011 – July 2016

A high-performing British international school. British International School of the Year 2011. IB Diploma averages of 37-38. Part of the Dulwich College International family of schools.

- Managed a **team of 16** (8 teaching assistants, 4 EAL teachers, 4 in-class support teachers), supporting instructional quality, inclusive practice, and professional growth.
- Built the school's **professional development infrastructure from scratch**, including the **Rolling PD program**: a peer-led model in which every teacher was required to design and deliver one in-house workshop per year and attend at least three others. Completion was a prerequisite for qualifying for external PD funding. The program turned 113 teachers into both presenters and learners, building internal capacity while aligning individual growth with school development needs, particularly the school's expanding "English Across the Curriculum" initiatives. All activity tracked through the **BlueSky PD management system**.
- Created faculty training initiatives (English for Parents, English for Teaching Assistants, Language Enrichment Group), a school-wide EAL resource hub, and aligned staff development with institutional priorities.
- Achieved a **12% increase in senior school student attainment** within one year through targeted academic intervention programs.
- Conducted **300+ admissions assessments annually** and built the department's standardized assessment framework: CAT4, NGRT, writing tasks, listening exams, and structured interviews. Interpreted results across multiple systems (GL Assessments, Cambridge Language Assessments, English National Curriculum levels, IB points, IELTS bands).
- **Taught**: IB English B, KS3 EAL, IGCSE EAL, KS3 English, SEN support, Intensive English, PSHE.
- Supervised Extended Essays and CAS; Year 11 Mentor, Form Tutor, Curriculum Committee member.
- Led **Language Perfect** competitive team to **3rd place globally**, with a student ranked **1st individually** (2014).
- **Debate Fellow**, Beihang World Debate Academy (2015); completed **100-hour International World Schools Debate Academy**, Kranjska Gora, Slovenia (2016).
- **Taught and organized the school's World's Largest Lesson** (September 2015), the UNICEF and Global Goals campaign lesson launching the new **UN Sustainable Development Goals** in 100+ countries. Began a decade of SDG teaching that continued in the (Un)Sustainability course at NYU Shanghai.

Bromsgrove International School, Bangkok, Thailand

Head of EAL | Head of House, Years 7-13 | Head of PSHE

January 2007 – June 2011

A diverse international boarding school offering a British curriculum to students from across Southeast Asia. CIS accredited.

- Led **combined academic and pastoral programming** across the secondary school in an international boarding context.
- Designed **inclusive curriculum and in-class support** for multilingual and diverse learners.
- Taught **IGCSE EAL, IGCSE Literature, mainstream English, IELTS**, and academic communication.
- Launched **debate programs** and integrated **United Nations days of celebration** into house activities.
- Contributed to **CIS accreditation** committees (English, PSHE).

International Language School (ILBC), Mandalay, Myanmar

K-12 English Teacher | Teacher Trainer

2004 – 2006

A K-12 school serving 800 students in Myanmar's second city. One of only two foreign staff in the entire town.

- Taught English across all year groups from kindergarten through Year 12, designing curriculum for every age and level.
- Built a **60-hour teacher training program in partnership with the British Council, Mandalay**, developing local teaching capacity where professional development was virtually nonexistent.
- **Contributing author**, *To Asia With Love* (ThingsAsian Press). **Honorable Mention, Travel Books, 2005 Independent Book Publishing Awards.**

Taylor College, Sydney, Australia

IELTS Instructor (part-time)

2003

University pathway college. IELTS instruction alongside MA TESOL studies at UNSW.

The Bangkok Post / Mon Culture & Literature Survival Project, Thailand

Published Columnist | Volunteer Literacy Teacher

2000 – 2003

- Wrote a weekly column, *Kat's Window on Thailand*, for Asia's second-largest English-language newspaper. Regular published column requiring deadline discipline, editorial voice, and cross-cultural explanation.
- Developed **literacy materials for refugees** in a camp in Sangkhlaburi on the Myanmar border, with the Mon Culture and Literature Survival Project.

The School for New Languages, Aarau, Switzerland

Cambridge English & IELTS Instructor, Kindergarten through Adults

1997 – 1999

Taught Cambridge English exam preparation and IELTS across a full age range in German-speaking Switzerland.

Springfield High School, Vermont, USA

German Teacher, Grades 7-12

1992 – 1996

Four years teaching secondary German. Taught in a district with a behavioral support program for at-risk teenagers and a class of children of American soldiers from the Vietnam War who arrived speaking no English. Taught them English from scratch. That dual placement is where the interest in SEN, EAL, and student welfare began.

SERVICE AND INSTITUTIONAL LEADERSHIP (NYU SHANGHAI)

- Chair, Faculty Community Connections Committee
- Chair/Leader, DEI Faculty Initiatives
- Coordinated Community Connections guest speaker event with the Writing Program: *Black Girl from Pyongyang* with memoirist Monica Macías (Sep 2026, 65 attendees)
- Workshop Facilitator, Center for Student Belonging
- Campus Point of Contact and Advisor, UN Millennium Fellowship
- Co-Facilitator, LEAD Mentorship Program (8 mentees)
- Committee Member, Academic Program Review
- Chair, Culture and Heritage Exposition (inaugural)
- Advisor, Collective Voice Student Debate (2019-2021, 2024)
- Director/Performer, *The Great Gatsby* faculty-student production (2024)
- Faculty Advisor, Green Shanghai (2018-2020)
- Co-Founded NYU Shanghai Sustainability Committee (14+ initiatives)
- Event Ambassador, No Translation Needed
- Member, Space Use Committee

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

Founder, The Kitty Committee · Shanghai

December 2023 – Present

Student, faculty, and community partnership supporting the welfare and placement of homeless cats and kittens in Pudong; 293 members.

Community-Engaged Learning Partnerships

2016 – 2025

Designed and led a community-engaged experiential learning program connecting first-year students with Shanghai non-profits. Initiated the Stepping Stones Shanghai partnership at Harrow (2016) and sustained it through NYU Shanghai, where students also volunteered with Good-hope Bakery of Special Youth, Shanggang Elder Nursing Home, and other local organizations. Service assessed through reflective journals, SDG campaign presentations, and final persuasive presentations linking fieldwork to academic research.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND SHORT COURSES

- **Generative AI in Education**, University of Glasgow · 2026
- **Compass Education Sustainability Practitioners**, Licensed Tutor
- **Teaching ESL Students in Mainstream Classes: Language in Learning Across the Curriculum**, Licensed Tutor · Feb 2015
- **Certified Distance Education Instructor**, IDEC, Chicago · Apr 2018 · 20 hours
- **Project Management Professional (PMP) Training**, LearnSmart LLC / PMI · Jul 2017 · 35 hours
- **9th Annual International World Schools Debate Academy**, Kranjska Gora, Slovenia · Jun-Jul 2016 · 100 hours
- **Debate Fellow**, Beihang World Debate Academy · 2015
- **International Society for Autism Research Conference**, Shanghai · Nov 2016
- **Advanced Safeguarding Children Training**, High Speed Training Ltd, UK · Dec 2017 (superseded by 2025 Designated Safeguarding Lead Training)
- **Beta testing: Blended IELTS Learning Platform**, CollegePre / Cambridge University Press / Cambridge Assessment · 2011-2016

PRESENTATIONS AND PUBLICATIONS

- **Presenter**, JALT Summer Symposium: *Performance in Education*, Okinawa, Japan · 2019
- **Presenter**, Center for Teaching and Learning non-conference on role-playing pedagogy, NYU Shanghai
- **Contributing author**, *To Asia With Love: A Connoisseurs' Guide to Cambodia, Laos, Thailand, and Vietnam* (ThingsAsian Press). Honorable Mention, 2005 Independent Book Publishing Awards.
- **Weekly columnist**, *Kat's Window on Thailand*, The Bangkok Post (2000-2003)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

TESOL International Association · British Association for Applied Linguistics (BAAL) · International AI in Education Society · Digital Education Council · Associate Member, MCN Civic Learning Council (Millennium Campus Network)

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS

National Professional Qualification for Headship (NPQH), UCL Institute of Education · In progress, expected May 2027

Implementation project: AI and Academic Integrity

Postgraduate Certificate in Inclusion and Special Needs (SENCO), University of Wolverhampton · Jan 2014 – Jul 2015

National Award for Special Educational Needs Coordinator

Diploma in Special Education Needs, The Blackford Centre, Somerset, UK · 2014

MA, TESOL / Applied Linguistics (with distinction), University of New South Wales, Sydney · 2002 – 2004

BA, Literary and Cultural Studies; Creative Writing and Composition | Minor: German, University of Vermont · 1987 – 1992

Licensure: Vermont English Language Arts Teaching License, Grades 7-12 (#123584509), valid through Jun 2029, Highly Qualified Teacher Status. School Leadership Licensure Assessment (SLLA 6990) score 164 (passed). Designated Safeguarding Lead Training, Caredemy, UK (2025-2027).

LANGUAGES

English – native. **German** – professional fluency (university minor; taught German grades 7-12; deepened through two years in German-speaking Switzerland).

Professional references available on request. · Katherine Tosi · September 2026